bank account down to $3,330. As I said in my diary on that date, rather gloomily, "We are now the proud possessors of a closet on the first floor of 213 Dean Street, Brooklyn."

4

Meanwhile, though, on August 20, I had picked up the September 1946 Astounding, which contained "Evidence." 1 Could I have imagined when I mailed off the story from Hawaii four months before that I'd be reading it in the magazine as a civilian?

On August 22, 1946, I received my Social Security number: 055-24-6410.

That same day I received a letter from Gerry Cohen. He was still at Aberdeen Proving Grounds and he was under the impression I was still at Operation Crossroads.

On August 30, Katherine Tarrant told me of a new anthology, Adventure in Time and Space, edited by Raymond J. Healy and J. Francis McComas. It was a large Modern Library giant put out by Random House and contained a number of the best pieces of the Golden Age of magazine science fiction.

One of the stories it contained was "Nightfall," the second of my stories to be anthologized. For it, Katherine said, I would get $66.50 (the check arrived on September 7). I now thought of that sum as representing six weeks' rent or one year's gas and electricity.

I bought a copy of the anthology—$3.01 with tax.

5 On September 4, 1946, we moved into 213 Dean Street. It was the first time we had an apartment of our own, however small, in almost exactly a year, and the first time ever in Greater New York

1 See I, Robot.

And on September 6, my letters to the various specialists began to return, marked "moved—address unknown." By now, apparently, Operation Crossroads had broken up. The original estimate of six months had been fair enough after all.

On September 9, I went to see Campbell and brought up "Little Lost Robot" for further discussion. I had made two false starts. Campbell pressed to have me try again, and we even discussed two more Foundation stories.